

Indian contingent



Men

Jadumani Singh (55kg), **Sachin Siwach** (60kg), **Sumit Kundu** (70kg), **Ankush** (80kg), **Kapil Pokhariya** (90kg), **Narender Berwal** (90+kg)

Women

Sakshi Chaudhary (51kg), **Preeti Pawar** (54kg), **Priya Ghanghas** (60kg), **Parveen Hooda** (65kg), **Lovlina Borgohain** (75kg)

TOTAL MEDALS AT STAKE

44

PTI

BOXING

PREETI PAWAR

Preeti Pawar (in pic, blue) arrives at the Asian Games with perhaps the strongest claim of any Indian boxer to gold. The 22-year-old Olympian from Paris has enjoyed an impressive run of form over the last year that has established her as one of the top contenders in the women's 54kg category. She won gold at the World Boxing Cup in New Delhi in November last year and maintained her momentum this season, winning gold at both the Asian Championships and Commonwealth Games.

Her Asian Championship triumph in Ulaanbaatar was particularly significant. Pawar defeated Olympic bronze medallist Im Ae-jiin the semifinals before securing a unanimous 5-0 victory over three-time world champion and Olympic bronze medallist Huang Hsiao-wen of Chinese Taipei in the final. It was a statement victory against one of Asia's most accomplished boxers and confirmed that Pawar's game has developed considerably since she won bronze at the 2022 Asian Games.

That gold was followed by Pawar's first gold medal at a multi-sport Games - the Commonwealth Games in Glasgow. Although the field wasn't nearly as strong as the one she overcame in Ulaanbaatar, the victory will only boost her confidence ahead of the Games in Nagoya.

54 KG

